

SAFE WORK METHOD STATEMENT

Persons responsible for supervising, inspecting work, work methods, plant & equipment and tools	Supervisor/Foreman	Date:	
High Risk Construction Work:	LOADING, TRANSPORTING AND UNLOADING MOBILE PLANT/EQUIPMENT	Project:	
SWMS prepared by Patrick Monaghan - Paneltec Group -Operations Manager and in consultation with management and workers – 2025. SWMS Review Date: August 2026 unless required earlier		Location:	
Approval to use this SWMS: "I certify that the attached SWMS has been reviewed by me, is endorsed for compliance with WorkSafe guidelines and is approved for use"			
<u>John Guy</u> Name	<u>Director - Paneltec Pty Ltd</u> Position	<u>0408 449 023</u> 	<u>31/08/2025 – V12.0</u> Date

RISK MATRIX

Level	Description of Consequence or Impact	Consequence	Likelihood / Probability		
			L <i>Likely</i>	M <i>Moderate</i>	U <i>Unlikely</i>
H (1) <i>(High level of harm)</i>	Potential death, permanent disability or major structural failure/damage. Off-site environmental discharge/release not contained and significant long-term environmental harm.	H (1) <i>(High)</i>	1	1	2
M (2) <i>(Medium level of harm)</i>	Potential temporary disability or minor structural failure/damage. On-site environmental discharge/release contained, minor remediation required, short-term environmental harm.	M (2) <i>(Medium)</i>	1	2	3
L (3) <i>(Low level of harm)</i>	Incident that has the potential to cause persons to require first aid. On-site environmental discharge/release immediately contained, minor level clean up with no short-term environmental harm.	L (3) <i>(Low)</i>	2	3	3
Level	Likelihood / Probability				
Likely	Could happen frequently				
Moderate	Could happen occasionally				
Unlikely	May occur only in exceptional circumstances				

HIERARCHY OF RISK CONTROL

The hierarchy of controls must be applied in the order below for all identified hazards.

Level 1 Eliminate the hazard
Level 2 Substitute the hazard with something safer.
Level 3 Isolate the hazard from people. Reduce the risks through engineering controls.
Level 4 Reduce exposure to the hazard using administrative actions.
Level 5 Use personal protective equipment
The control measures that you put in place should be reviewed regularly to make sure they work as planned

ACTIVITY ANALYSIS

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls in Place
Training and skill.	Un-trained persons could cause injury to themselves and others. Possible property damage.	1	1. All persons on site must carry with them a current 'Construction Induction Card'. 2. Truck drivers must hold a Heavy Vehicle Drivers Licence HC 3. No person shall operate mobile plant without the appropriate licence or competency assessment. 4. Drivers to have attended Crane & Plant Overhead Electrical Course.	Management	2
Personal Protective Clothing & Equipment (PPE)	Personal injury.	1	1. Minimum PPE to be worn on site is: • Hi visibility vests/clothing • Steel toe-capped boots • UV skin protection minimum 15+ UV sunscreen • Head protection as applicable • Long pants and long sleeves where applicable.	Truck driver	2
Traffic management On roadside or Worksite.	Various injuries from collision with traffic or other plant. Pedestrians could be injured if they intrude into loading/unloading area.	1	1. Traffic management is to be provided where required by the Supervisor or the Contractor. 2. Persons not involved in unloading of plant to be kept clear of the area at least 10m. 3. All floats and trucks to have operating reversing beepers and flashing orange lights. 4. Truck controller to be used as required eg where there is restricted rear vision.	Supervisor	2
Site Access	Various injuries from collision with traffic or other plant. Possible property damage.	1	1. Comply with speed limits on and around site. 2. Drive only in designated access routes. 3. Do not park vehicles where it will create a hazard to public vehicles, mobile plant, pedestrians or other workers. 4. Park on level ground. 5. Limit reversing on site where possible & use a truck controller where required.	Truck driver	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls in Place
Hitching tow vehicle to trailer or low loader	Property damage and/or personal injury. Possible crushing injuries from breakaway of trailer or low loader. People. Traffic. Night (Darkness).	1	1. Attach tow couplings securely to towing vehicle (as there are so many different types of tow hitches and couplings ensure you have been shown how to correctly secure the type you use). 2. Use lock pins and safety latches where provided. 3. Attach all breakaway safety chains securely to towing vehicle. 4. Inspect tow coupling and safety chains before use; do not rely on bystanders to secure tow couplings and safety chains. The driver is responsible for securing the tow coupling. 5. Do not tow or use vehicles or plant with faulty tow couplings or safety chains, report faults to your manager immediately. 6. Ensure to connect the braking and light systems correctly. 7. Check all lights and braking systems prior to loading plant/equipment. 8. It is the driver's responsibility to ensure the trailer is secured correctly. 9. Ensure reversing beeper is working. 10. Use mirrors when reversing. 11. Turn on revolving flashing light. 12. Use spotlight, which is mounted at the rear of the cab, to help visibility at night.	Truck Driver	2
Check tyres, light and brakes etc.	Traffic.	1	1. Wear a high visibility vest when walking around the float inspecting the tyres, lights etc. (IMPORTANT: White overalls with retro-reflective tape must be worn at night; no exceptions).	Truck Driver	2
Travel to pick up/drop off location	Traffic. People.	1	1. As a professional driver, drive truck in accordance with the Heavy Vehicle's Drivers Licence. (Roads & Maritime Services Road Rules).	Truck Driver	2
Look for suitable location to park to load/ unload.	Traffic. People. Overhead power lines. Overhanging tree branches. Residential Areas. Uneven ground. Wet weather.	1	1. Park at a safe distance away from street corners and avoid narrow streets. 2. Park at a safe distance from low lying power lines and overhanging tree branches. N.B. Be cautious of height issues. 3. Avoid early morning shifts in residential areas if possible. 4. Avoid confrontations with the public and report all complaints. 5. Park on firm level ground. 6. Avoid dirt areas, which may become boggy during wet weather.	Truck Driver	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls in Place
Lower/raise ramps and put legs in place.	People. Traffic. Objects.	1	1. Make sure area is clear of any objects or persons prior to lowering ramps. 2. Move truck forward and look for a more suitable location if ramps are not sitting level on ground.	Truck Driver	2
Check machines to be transported.	Vandalism to machines. Theft.	1	1. A pre – transport check of brakes, tyres, etc is carried out visually. 2. Obvious visual problems such as punctured tyres, cut hydraulic hoses, engine covers off machined etc, can generally be picked up by the driver. REPORT ALL OBVIOUS DAMAGE. 3. It is important to report when machines are found “unlocked”.	Truck Driver	2
Arranging loads	Trailer or tipper body failure. Equipment slipping from trailer. Machine loading configuration. Size of machines	1	1. Ensure that your vehicles load space and the condition of it's loading deck are suitable for the type & size of the load to be carried. 2. Check the weight of the proposed load to be carried. 3. Check the positioning of the load along the vehicle. 4. Do not overload the vehicle or it's individual axles. 5. Do not reduce the weight on the steer axle where applicable by placing the load too far back. 6. Do not overload the steer axle where applicable by placing the load too far forward. 7. Do not allow the load to project dangerously towards the cabin or outside the vehicle unless specific permits allow. 8. A steel drum roller for example should not be loaded on to a steel deck unless rubber matting (eg conveyor belting) has first been laid on the deck – this will prevent the machine from slipping. This is especially important in damp or wet weather. 9. Check that loads DO NOT exceed width and height restrictions. All drivers MUST be familiar with these restrictions.	Truck Driver	2
Loading or Unloading Plant or Equipment	Various injuries and or property damage. Traffic people	1	1. Persons not involved in loading or unloading of plant/equipment to be kept clear of the area at least 10m in case the load falls or topples from the trailer or float. 2. Load and unload on stable, level ground. 3. Apply the brakes of the transporter and chock its wheels to prevent movement when required. 4. Make sure that portable loading ramps are reasonably clean, firm, secure, and in line with the deck.	Supervisor Truck Driver	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls in Place
			5. Carefully line up the machine with the ramp and float. 6. Use low gear only when loading/unloading machines. 7. Position the machine so that its weight is correctly distributed on the float. 8. Lower all attachments, lock the brakes, chock the wheels or tracks when required and secure the machine with cables or chains of adequate strength. 9. When loading disabled machines or heavy plant with winches, take care that the winch speed is low enough for the operator of the machine being loaded to maintain control of the machine. 10. When side loading, ensure that blocks are placed under both sides of the float to prevent swaying. 11. If someone is assisting to load plant/equipment they must be ticketed/competent in the plant they are driving and you need to make sure you are both familiar with the hand signals used in the loading and unloading of machines. 12. Always wear the seatbelt where fitted when loading & unloading plant/equipment. 13. Avoid parking machines on slopes.		
	Wet weather	1	1. Be careful when loading in wet weather because the deck can be slippery. 2. Use timber or conveyor rubber on deck when loading steel on steel. 3. Use wet weather gear supplied.	Truck Driver	2
Secure plant/equipment	Machines could become dislodged and fall from low loader which would create a major hazards for traffic, people and / or property. Using the older style dog (anchor type) can be awkward and dangerous to the low loader driver and the public.	1	1. Ensure that plant is lashed/chained in accordance with the recommendations in the "load restraint guide". 2. Ensure chains and load binders ("dogs") are in good condition, (replace and / or report when new chains / dogs are required). 3. Use the correct number of chains and dogs for the load configurations to be floated. Always keep a tally as to the number of chains used during a float shift. This will help reduce the number lost during float moves. 4. Ensure the machines are tied down using the appropriate "tie – down" locations.	Truck Driver	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls in Place
			5. Use a chaffing strip such as a piece of hose or tyre placed between the chain and the machinery where required to protect the chains. e.g. traveling long distances to prevent chain rubbing through and breaking. 6. Ensure parts or attachments such as buckets, dipper arms or any loose items are securely lashed. 7. It is the driver's responsibility to ensure his load is properly secured. 8. Check lashings or chains at periodic intervals when doing long hauls.		
	Crushing injuries including hands & feet from improperly loaded Equipment, wedging of the body between truck tray & the load.	1	1. Personal care must be taken at all times & wearing of appropriate PPE to limit exposure to crushing, gloves, hard hat when required & steel capped boots to be worn. 2. Loads to be secured at all times. 3. Load binders, straps, chains & load dogs to be inspected before use. Use only approved lifting chains & or slings in good condition. 4. Truck mounted cranes & or tilt trays are only to be used also on a firm level surface with outrigger legs fully extended. 5. Do not use cranes or winches to secure load. 6. Never stand between load and truck tray.	Truck Driver	2
	Exposure to electric shock from chains, equipment, truck mounted crane & or tilt tray coming into contact with live power lines.	1	1. Exercise extreme care when using chains, truck mounted crane or tilt tray, keep the minimum distance away from any power line. Before loading, tying down, lifting or tilting operations LOOK UP for power lines.	Truck Driver	2
	Falling, tripping & slipping from tray of truck or float.	1	1. Personal care must be taken at all times & wearing of appropriate PPE including rubber soled & steel capped boots. 2. Access vehicle tray via fitted step ladders and access ramps, do not jump from truck trays. 3. Do not jump from trailer to ground – climb down safely maintaining 3 points of contact at all times.	Truck Driver	2
	Head Injuries from contact with load or chains & slings.	1	1. Personal care must be taken at all times & wearing of appropriate PPE including hard hat.	Truck Driver	2
	Manual handling injuries.	1	1. Take care when moving ramps and if an item is too heavy or awkward as for assistance.	Truck Driver	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls in Place
	High noise levels.	2	1. Appropriate hearing protection must be worn where signed when loading/unloading plant/equipment.	Truck Driver	3
	Exposure to natural elements, sun, rain, glare & wind.	1-3	1. Personal care to be taken at all times. 2. Appropriate PPE to be worn wet weather gear. 3. Be careful of slippages in wet weather.	Truck Driver	2-3
	A problem arises during the loading process that could cause possible damage to the equipment. This could be “driver error” or “outside influences”.	1	IMPORTANT: Always phone for help /advice if a problem arises. Never proceed if unsure or lacking confidence during loading. Damage to mobile equipment, that could have been avoided, will not be tolerated.	Truck Driver	2
Raise Ramps	People. Traffic. Objects.	2	1. Make sure area is clear of obstruction. 2. Turn revolving light on the rear of low loader (manual operation). 3. Ensure parking lights are on during transporting. Signs and flags must be fit for purpose. Drivers should report damaged items and get them replaced ASAP. 4. Remember to manually raise legs from under low loader before driving off.	Truck Driver	3
Driving laden vehicles	Loss of control of vehicle. Excessive movement may dislodge load.	1	As a professional driver, drive truck in accordance with the Heavy Vehicle Drivers Licence. (Roads & Maritime Services Road Rules). 1. Remember the size, nature and position of the load will effect the handling of the vehicle. 2. Be aware that loads can settle and shift during a journey, causing lashings to slacken. 3. Check your load periodically. 4. Check your load after emergency braking or an excessively sharp manoeuvre. 5. Do not move your vehicle unless the load is properly restrained. 6. Do not take any risks.	Truck Driver	2
	Blown tyre.	1	1. If a steer tyre has blown try to reduce speed and keep on road alignment if possible. 2. Apply trailer brake to slow the vehicle up (if trailer connected). Also the maxi brake on the truck may be used.	Truck Driver	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls in Place
			3. Avoid the foot pedal as this will apply brake pressure to the steer axle and tend to make direction of steering more difficult.		
Releasing load binders	Serious bodily injuries.	1	1. Prior to releasing load binders ensure you are aware that dog chains release with a great amount of force and speed and can cause serious injuries. Care must be taken to ensure, when using the older style load binder (anchor type), that the pipe used to loosen the binders does not spring out of the driver's hand. 2. When releasing load binders, operators are to stand in a safe position. 3. The preference is to use a ratchet type restraint where practicable. 4. Ensure people stand clear during the unchaining operation. 5. Place all chains and dogs on the deck of low loader or store in correct place on truck.	Truck Driver	2
Over dimensional loads- 4.6m plus E.G. Shuttle Buggy	Vehicle load failure. Striking overhead obstruction. Vehicle more difficult to control. Bridges Power Line Overhanging trees Road signs	1	1. Position loads so that the carrying vehicle weights are not exceeded. 2. Check that height restrictions are adhered too. 3. Ensure that plant is lashed in accordance with the recommendations in the "load restraint guide". 4. Ensure all signs and flags etc are installed prior to leaving site. 5. Use main road routes and avoid residential roads 6. Watch for height limit signs 7. Route to be assessed prior to use. 8. Drop off location to be finalised prior to delivery.	Truck Driver	2
Environmental Issues	Transmission of material off site, eg mud or spread noxious weeds from truck tyres.	2	1. Where possible endeavor to not park in muddy areas. 2. Where a tyre wash system has been set up by the principle contractor then it should be used.	Truck Driver	3
	Dust/dirt on low loader deck after unloading.	3	1. Sweep deck with broom to avoid material blowing off onto vehicles / traffic.	Truck Driver	3
Lock Machines	Vandalism Theft of machines	1	1. Drivers to secure all machines properly with the padlocks supplied.	Truck Driver	2
Site security; un-authorised access.	Possible injury to un-authorized persons entering the work depot.	2	1. Close gates etc on departure where applicable.	Truck Driver	3

ENVIRONMENTAL RISK ASSESSMENT & CONTROL MEASURES THAT MAY BE REQUIRED ON SITE DEPENDING ON THE ACTIVITY					
Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Emergencies	Accident/ Incident Fire Spill	1	1. Personnel have been advised at toolbox meeting and are prepared in the event of an incident occurring. 2. Emergency numbers available on site. 3. Fire Extinguishers/First Aid Kits/Spill Kits on site.	Supervisor All	2
Air Quality	Exhaust Fumes Dust	2	1. Control exhaust emissions eg. Regular maintenance, replace old machinery, fit appropriate emission control measures. 2. Dampen milled surface with water cart. 3. Use water cart where required.	Supervisor All	3
Bitumen/Prime	During heavy rain, recently placed prime or bitumen could emulsify and wash into surrounding waterways.	1	1. Plan prime or bitumen operation so that it is conducted during fine weather. 2. Have material available to clean up a spill if it occurs and dispose of contaminated material accordingly. 3. Protect storm drains during and after application to prevent pollution - have spill clean-up materials available.	Supervisor All	2
Community Relations	Inconvenience as a result of works/traffic management	2	1. Identify from the list of potentially impacted parties who may be impacted by the work being undertaken. 2. Letter drops could be considered (unless specifically required) to notify residents/businesses etc. about works to be undertaken and if it has an effect on them.	Supervisor All	3
Flora & Fauna	Some works may require the removal of vegetation. Native fauna may be at risk from excavation works	2	1. Assess work area for significant vegetation: size of trees, faunal habitat - define work and exclusion areas using fencing and signage. 2. Machinery is to be thoroughly washed down prior to leaving site where noxious weeds are present.	Supervisor All	3
Heritage & Archaeology	Unmonitored excavation at significant sites can lead to loss or destruction of valuable artifacts/relics, and disturbance of historical sites. including cultural heritage and/or archaeological significance	1	1. Undertake a survey of the site to identify any areas of significance. The client's representative may undertake this. Government bodies may be able to assist. 2. Develop a project specific procedure based on the findings and recommendations. 3. Installation of exclusion fencing and signage if required.	Supervisor All	2

Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Noise Pollution, Community Relations & Vibration	Sensitivity to noise - to public & fauna	1	1. Work undertaken during “normal” hours where possible. 2. Affected residents notified in person or in writing. 3. Plant and equipment regularly serviced & fitted with efficient mufflers. 4. Magnitude of vibration reduced by using smaller plant etc.	Supervisor All	2
Soil Management & Water Quality	Soil needs to be managed to ensure that; there are no off-site impacts. Damage to stockpile areas (not prepared properly). Mud deposited onto roadways.	2	1. Wash down machinery in only nominated areas. 2. Not within 20 metres of water courses. 3. Use only approved and nominated stockpile areas. 4. Build bund wall out of material available on site. 5. Drivers to check vehicle tyres/bodies for build up of mud when leaving stockpile sites and remove if necessary.	Supervisor All	3
Fuels and Chemicals	Contamination of waterways due to spillages of oil, degreasers, diesel, etc.	1	1. Store fuel and chemicals in accordance with relevant standards/guidelines. 2. Minimise storage on site and locate storage facilities away from drains and waterways. 3. All containers clearly labelled and Safety Data Sheets are available on site. 4. All drums stored securely and in a bunded area. 5. Spill kits or alternative spill containment materials available on site. 6. Regular maintenance of plant hoses. 7. Use correct refuelling equipment.	Supervisor All	2
Visual Impact Litter and Amenities Waste Management	Litter such as paper, plastic, and other refuse as well as being a possible safety risk may be carried off-site or washed into waterways resulting in pollution and danger to native fauna. Litter is also visually obtrusive. Production generated lighting, litter, mud, dirt and dust may also impact residents.	2	1. Use site induction to communicate the requirement for a tidy site. Also stress consideration for local residents. 2. If as a result of our works, dirt, mud, or litter affects a resident, then we will rectify this problem immediately. 3. Inspect the site frequently and insist on tidiness. Ensure public roads are free of dirt/mud from the work site. 4. Broken-out paved surfaces shall be repaired as soon as possible. 5. Remove all rubbish from site each day. 6. Waste asphalt will be recycled where possible.	Supervisor All	3

Personal Protective Equipment

All site personnel must wear the required PPE specified in the controls above, such as:

Safety Hi-vis Vests/Shirts	Safety Boots	Sunscreen	Broad Brimmed Sun Hat	Sunglasses	Gloves specific to the task	White reflective overalls/night
Hard Hat where required	Safety Glasses	Hearing protection where required	Long clothing	Dust masks	Respiratory equipment if required	

Workers may require Task Specific Training depending on activity each worker will be required to fulfill.

All workers shall hold a current Construction Induction Card						
- If required Client Site Induction - Activity Induction (SWMS & SWP's)	Vehicle Licences (Car or Truck depending on class of vehicle or mobile plant driven)	Plant Operators licences or competency assessments where required	Competencies for Work Zone Traffic Management			
First Aid certificate training	Manual Handling training	Fire Extinguisher training	Fatigue Management Training			

A Site Specific Induction & Toolbox Meeting will be held each day prior to the start of each job.

Legislation & Codes of Practice (refer to company Legislation register for applicable Australian Standards applicable to works)

Work Health & Safety Act 2012 and Work Health & Safety Regulations 2022

Codes of Practice

Confined Spaces - 2020	Hazardous Manual Tasks - 2020	Managing Noise & Preventing Hearing Loss at Work-2020	Managing Risks of Plant in the Workplace - 2018
Construction Work - 2020	How to Manage WH&S Risks - 2018	Managing Risk of Falls at Workplaces - 2020	Managing Electrical Risks in the Workplace -2019
Excavation Work - 2020	First Aid in the Workplace - 2018	Managing Work Environment & Facilities - 2020	WHS Consultation Co-operation & Co-ordination - 2018
Welding Processes - 2021	How to Safely Remove Asbestos - 2020	Managing Risk of Hazardous Chemicals - 2018	Safe Design of Structures - 2018

Plant & Equipment for this activity

- All plant is inspected prior to sending out to site
- Daily maintenance & service checks.
- Daily pre-start checks are conducted on all plant and trucks by the operators and daily checklist filled out.
- Regular servicing at 250hr intervals or as per manufactures specifications. Service History available on request to the office.

List of plant for this Activity

Engineering details/certificates/regulatory approvals/permits/electrical isolation (if applicable):

Implementation, Monitoring and Review of SWMS

The Supervisor on site has the responsibility to:

- Brief each team member on this SWMS before commencing work.
- Ensure control measures have been implemented prior to the start of works.
- Observe work being carried out.
- If controls documented in SWMS are not adequate, stop the work, review the SWMS, adjust as required and re-brief the team.
- Ensure team knows that work is to immediately stop if the SWMS is not being followed.
- Retain this SWMS on site for the duration of the high-risk construction work.
- All persons involved in these particular tasks on site must sign this document as read and understood.

SWMS attendance sheet — I have been given the opportunity to provide input into the development and review of this SWMS

Name (please print clearly)	Signature	Company	Date

Daily pre-start meetings will be held to ensure all workers are informed of control measures and additional safety hazards & controls to be noted on toolbox form.